WEEK 6 · LECTURE L2 · UNIT II

Integration and User Adoption

Why a stack of good tools becomes a bad system, and why people still do not use what was built for them.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain point solutions, data silos and APIs, and the arithmetic of integration.
- Apply UTAUT, TAM2 and TAM3 to diagnose adoption failure.
- Apply van Dijk's successive access model and Granovetter's weak ties to champions networks.
- Evaluate change management approaches, including Kotter, for HR technology rollouts.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 2 (integration and user adoption).

INTEGRATION

Many systems means many possible connections

The arithmetic

With n systems, possible point-to-point links are n(n − 1) ÷ 2. Sixteen systems give 120.

A data silo

Data locked in one system that others cannot read, so people re-key it by hand.

An API, in plain terms

An agreed way for one system to ask another for data, like a counter window with a fixed form.

Private spreadsheets with no integrations are where the silos meet, by hand.

VENKATESH ET AL. (2003)

UTAUT: four factors that drive use

Factor	Question	Typical HR failure
Performance expectancy	Will this help me do my job?	The tool solves HR's problem, not the employee's
Effort expectancy	Is it easy to use?	Desktop-style forms on a small phone
Social influence	Do people who matter expect me to use it?	Supervisors still accept paper
Facilitating conditions	Do I have the device, data and support?	No smartphone, no data, no help desk in my language

EXAM LENS

Moderators: gender, age, experience and voluntariness. Diagnose which factor fails before choosing a fix; retraining fixes none of these alone.

A TYPICAL PATTERN IN ADOPTION DATA

Use rises with literacy and device, not with training

Literacy

Active use often jumps sharply between low and moderate digital literacy, where most of the gap lies.

Device

Laptop users show near-universal use; feature phone users show almost none.

Training

Completing a training module often makes little difference when the barrier is access or literacy.

EXAM LENS

This is the facilitating conditions factor at work. Training addresses effort expectancy at best; it cannot supply a device.

People adopt through people

Champions

Trusted peers who use the tool and help others.

Where they usually are

Champions cluster among laptop users and are scarce among smartphone-only staff, exactly where they are needed.

The fix

Recruit champions at frontline sites, give them time, and recognize the help they give.

EXERCISE

Diagnose why a good tool failed

Step	Question to answer
1. Choose	Pick one under-used tool: self-service app, pulse survey or wellbeing app
2. Locate	Which UTAUT factor fails: performance, effort, social influence or facilitating conditions?
3. Evidence	What data would show it: device access, literacy, manager behavior?
4. Fix	Propose one change targeting that factor, not generic retraining

EXAM LENS

If your fix would work equally well for every factor, it does not diagnose anything.

Why people find a system useful or easy

THE CORE IDEA

TAM2 and TAM3 explain where the two TAM beliefs (usefulness, ease of use) come from, not just their effect.

HOW IT WORKS

Usefulness grows with job relevance, output quality and visible results; ease of use grows with computer self-efficacy and hands-on experience.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

The models grow long and specific, and still explain intention better than actual use.

IN PRACTICE

Show an employee a result they care about, such as leave approved in minutes, to build perceived usefulness.

EXAM LENS

Trace the lineage: TAM (Davis, 1989), TAM2, TAM3, UTAUT. Showing the evolution demonstrates depth.

THEORY IN DEPTH · VAN DIJK (2005)

Access comes in four successive stages

THE CORE IDEA

Digital access is not a yes-or-no switch but four stages, each needing the one before.

HOW IT WORKS

Motivation, then physical access, then skills, then actual use. A gap at any stage stops the rest.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

The stages overlap in real life, and motivation can follow skill rather than precede it.

IN PRACTICE

Feature phone users fail at physical access; many smartphone users fail at skills. Each needs a different remedy.

EXAM LENS

Link to the three-level divide (Week 2): van Dijk adds motivation as the first stage.

THEORY IN DEPTH · GRANOVETTER (1973)

New ideas travel through weak ties

THE CORE IDEA

Weak ties, such as acquaintances in other groups, carry new information farther than close friends do.

HOW IT WORKS

Close friends know what you know; bridges between groups bring in the new.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Strong ties matter more for trust and for adopting risky changes.

IN PRACTICE

A roving champion who visits several sites spreads awareness; a trusted co-worker at the same site drives actual use.

EXAM LENS

Use weak ties for awareness and strong ties for adoption; distinguishing them shows analytical precision.

THEORY IN DEPTH · KOTTER (1996)

Eight steps, and most failures are in the first three

THE CORE IDEA

Urgency, a guiding coalition, a vision, communication, removing obstacles, short-term wins, consolidating gains, anchoring in culture.

HOW IT WORKS

Kotter found that skipping early steps produced the illusion of speed, then failure.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

A top-down sequence; critics argue real change loops back and needs more bottom-up voice.

IN PRACTICE

Removing obstacles for frontline adoption means devices and language, not more announcements.

EXAM LENS

Pair Kotter with UTAUT: Kotter tells you the sequence; UTAUT tells you which obstacle to remove.

PRACTICE FOR THE END-TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Training is the default response to low adoption, and usually the wrong one." Critically evaluate using UTAUT and van Dijk's access model. **20 marks**

A strong answer: diagnoses by factor and access stage; shows why training addresses only some barriers; proposes factor-specific remedies.

Explain why integration is the hidden cost of HR technology, and evaluate approaches to reducing it. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses the n(n − 1) ÷ 2 arithmetic; explains silos and APIs; compares point-to-point with a hub around a system of record.

How should champions networks be designed, according to Granovetter? **10 marks**

A strong answer: distinguishes weak and strong ties and assigns each a role.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. **Every extra system multiplies the connections that must work**
2. **Diagnose which adoption factor fails before choosing a fix**
3. **Champions must sit where adoption is lowest**

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

- Venkatesh, V., Morris, M. G., Davis, G. B., & Davis, F. D. (2003). User acceptance of information technology. *MIS Quarterly, 27*(3), 425–478.
- Manuti, A., & de Palma, P. D. (2018), Chapters 4 and 5 (social collaboration platforms and the PPP3.0 case).

COMPANION

Each set reading is explained in the matching Unit Reader on rksingh.tech/materials.

THEORY SOURCES · FOR REFERENCE

Sources for this lecture

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Davis, F. D. (1989). Perceived usefulness, perceived ease of use, and user acceptance of information technology. *MIS Quarterly, 13*(3), 319–340. https://doi.org/10.2307/249008

Granovetter, M. S. (1973). The strength of weak ties. *American Journal of Sociology, 78*(6), 1360–1380. https://doi.org/10.1086/225469

Kotter, J. P. (1996). *Leading change*. Harvard Business School Press.

Manuti, A., & de Palma, P. D. (2018). *Digital HR: A critical management approach to the digitilization of organizations*. Palgrave Macmillan.

van Dijk, J. A. G. M. (2005). *The deepening divide: Inequality in the information society*. Sage.

Venkatesh, V., & Bala, H. (2008). Technology acceptance model 3 and a research agenda on interventions. *Decision Sciences, 39*(2), 273–315. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-5915.2008.00192.x

Venkatesh, V., & Davis, F. D. (2000). A theoretical extension of the technology acceptance model: Four longitudinal field studies. *Management Science, 46*(2), 186–204. https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.46.2.186.11926

Sources for this lecture (continued)

Venkatesh, V., Morris, M. G., Davis, G. B., & Davis, F. D. (2003). User acceptance of information technology: Toward a unified view. *MIS Quarterly, 27*(3), 425–478. https://doi.org/10.2307/30036540